

MINUTES OF PUBLIC MEETING HELD FEBURARY 4, 2021 OF GRADUATE AND PROFESSIONAL STUDENT COUNCIL, GENERAL COUNCIL

A public meeting of the Graduate and Professional Student Council, General Council was convened on Thursday, Feburary 4th, 2021 at **6:43** PM held exclusively on ZOOM.

Present at the meeting were the following members of the Graduate and Professional Student Council & Executive Board: Shilpita Sen, Adam Roussas, Shelby Miller, Srishti Gupta, Sarah Abney, Alaina Puff, Morgan Byrd, Daniel Lewis, Sonia Kaufman, Yi Zhang, Rachel Ference, Tala Shahin, Niels Mohty, Issac Stein, Norma Villagomez-Marquez, Joseph Agosttini, Dexter Gulick, Jennifer Beyer, Jhonatan Henao-Munoz, Priya Zukosky, Saiying Tina Ge, Zara Ahmad-Post, Kayla Beard, Dustin Tran, Juliana Richter, Miranda Yousif, Zufan Yegezu, Krupa Bhakta, Kelli Lycke Martin;

Proxy denoted with asterisk (*)s

- Advisors and staff present were: Emily Earl;
- Guests present were::

Quorum met: **17** of **31** council members present.

The meeting was called to order at **6:43** pm and was adjourned at **8:07** pm:

- **Call to Order**
- **Call to Audience**
- **Land Acknowledgement Statement**
- **New Business**
 - a. Proposal Post GPSC Zoom Meetings
 - i. Goal: to further align with GPSC's statement to become a transparent representative body.
 - 1. Posting 24hr after GC meeting
 - ii. WHY?
 - 1. Produces a more accurate record that is usefull to all and would better allow understanding of the meeting
 - 2. Community outreach and inclusion – better allows for students in different timezones and students without reliable internet to stream live meetings.
 - iii. Discussion
 - 1. Public good
 - 2. No intent to restrcit recording to university personelle
 - 3. Daniel Lewis speaks in favor for this proposal indicating that this is of the best interests for students and constituents
 - 4. Kelli Lycke also speaks in favor indicating that it helps representatives recall information and allows them to send to respective constituents

5. Zufan Yegezu speaks in favor of the proposal as it increases transparency and accountability of the council.
6. Dustin Tran asked Issac Stein why this proposal would be better than the minutes
 - a. Issac's responded that the video is the most accurate representation of the meeting due to detailing and human error.
7. Historical Context:
 - a. Dustin Tran indicated that GPSC live streamed the recordings in the past, but stopped due to misinterpretation of representatives conversations from the public and skewed reporting.
 - b. Joseph Agosttini asked the office of the general council about this and was informed that GPSC is **not** obligated to release this information
8. Adam Roussas indicated that because GPSC is viewed as a shared governance organization, we should support this.
9. Zufan Yegezu suggested that we upload the verbatim transcript.
10. Issac Stein reaffirmed that the motivation behind this proposal is to show students that we are open and willing to being held accountable.
- b. Public Disclosure of GA/Rep Compensation
 - i. GPSC President, Vice President, and 5 student workers are employed as .5 FTE (32K-38.5K per year that includes tuition and free student health insurance per academic year
 - ii. Proposal: posting this information under "get involved tab" about GA compensation along the lines of:

What Would Public Disclosure Look Like?

(Text) Text: "GPSC's President and Vice President, as well as several of the organization's student worker positions, are .5 FTE Graduate Assistant (GA) positions. These positions confer the benefits found in the GA Student [Manual](#). These benefits currently include an annualized gross cash stipend of up to \$17,117 during the academic year, free student health insurance during the academic year, and qualified tuition reduction. GPSC Representatives do not have GA positions. They receive a cash stipend (gross pay) of \$83.33 per month of service.

To receive updates about vacancies in all of these positions, please subscribe to the GPSC listhost [here](#)."

- iii.
- iv. WHY?
 1. Diversity and Inclusion – increasing awareness for students who may think this is a volunteer position. Increasing transparency to increase application and representation of peoples.
- v. Discussion:
 1. Juliana Richter speaks in favor for this initiative to support students of other university organizations to provide a precedent for compensation of labor

2. Shelby Miller indicated a possible concern of releasing information on the website that may violate FERPA rules.
 - a. Isaac Stein expressed the need for generalization
 3. Dustin Tran indicated compensation is based on volunteering time not based off of time put in (i.e. hourly wage) and that they are publicly available in the budget every year. The vice-president position is determined every year and can be GA based or not.
 - a. Isaac Stein indicated that the risk of representatives joining for money is smaller than the risk of economically precluding students who are interested but can't take the non-compensated time to due to financial constraints
 4. Daniel Lewis indicated that many reps initially thought that their position was on a volunteer basis and that being open about compensation may influence more participation and filling of representative spots that are vacant at present.
 5. Adam Roussas indicated support for this proposal and acknowledged that the way in which this is enacted will be dynamic
 6. Dexter Gulick indicated support for this proposal and suggested that we post the stipend amount on the elections page.
 7. Dustin Tran inquired what the best way to disseminate this information
 - a. Issac Stein indicated that transparency and interested students weighing stipend in relation to current income outlets are public service
 8. Sarah Abney encouraged representatives to start disseminating information of these financial support opportunities to their constituency.
 9. Isaac Stein indicated his personal experience with disseminating information to constituencies which exemplified the need for centralized information due to the lack of information in a centralized fashion.
- c. ^The above proposals will be reviewed by EB prior to voting on them in a GC meeting.
 - d. Vice Presidents Report
 - i. Filled the communications director and elections director position
 - ii. Representatives should join the slack labelled "Graduate and Professional Student Council".
 - iii. Grants have been submitted to SSFAB to continue GPSC grants program
- **President's Report (as emailed to representatives)**
 - a. Grant Proposals: SSFAB
 - i. We recently submitted three proposals to the Student Services Fee Board for our grants programs for over a million dollars, including two multiyear proposals for ReaP, POD, and Showcase (3 - years), Promising Practice Grant (2 - years), and our annual Travel Grants.
 - b. Provost Investment Fund

- i. Currently working on finalizing two drafting proposals for grants that I recently submitted that would support the Promising Practice Grant (PPG) and Completion Grants program.
 - c. Childcare Subsidy:
 - i. Funding is still available, please apply at <https://lifework.arizona.edu/programs/childcare-choice/student>
 - d. Look out for upcoming events - <https://lifework.arizona.edu/events-workshops/parenting-workshops>
 - e. Opportunities for Involvement:
 - i. Arizona Online Advisory Working Group
 - ii. Volunteer to serve on a Pulse Survey – Office of Diversity & Inclusion
 - f. Tuition:
 - i. Updates to follow soon, the three University Presidents are meeting this evening with ABOR.
 - g. Office – Hours/ Meeting Hours:
 - i. Please feel free to schedule meetings to discuss constituent concerns/ questions/ discuss project ideas and updates.
 - ii. <https://doodle.com/mm/rntf43n6iyp9uusa>
- **Internal Committee Reports**
 - a. Appropriations
 - i. Email has been sent to set up monthly meetings this semester
 - ii. Will have an update next meeting
 - b. Policy
 - i. Committee is currently in planning stages for this semester.
 - c. Governing Documents
 - i. First meeting is next Wednesday at 4:15pm
 - ii. Will be reviewing feedback received in the last GC meeting
 - d. Social & Marketing
 - i. Meetings are on Mondays bi-monthly
 - ii. AD HOC Sexual Assault
 - 1. Met prior to the GC meeting to check-in on holiday progress
 - 2. Plan to release information in April for Sexual Assault Awareness Month.
- **Constituency Concerns**
 - a. GPSC listserv information dissemination (Dustin Tran)
 - i. Representatives are getting information at the same time and are requesting dissemination prior so that they are better prepared for constituency questions.
 - b. Humanities/Spanish TA's still are required to come in on reading days (Jhonatan Henao-Munoz)
 - i. Adam Roussas indicated if it is written in the contract, obligations are required – otherwise a student is not expected to work on those reading days
 - ii. There are anonymous reporting avenues for students if they are in need of support.
 - iii. Chemistry TA's were also mentioned as being affected by this concern.

- c. Common CAJUA (campus union organization) agenda (Jhonatan Henao-Munoz)
 - i. Shelby suggested that this be submitted as an agenda item for the next GC meeting.
- **Plans for Future Meetings**
 - a. Update of election timeline to allow representatives enough time to reach out to constituents about compensation and position obligations
 - b. Update of showcase
 - i. Adam Update: Registration was Jan. 29th but if the link is still live, anyone can sign up
 - 1. Submission deadline is February 10th
 - 2. Secured \$5,000 for special category awards (\$500 for each undergraduate and graduate student winner of each category)
 - 3. Graduate students can judge only undergraduate presentations while faculty/staff will be judging graduate student presentations
 - ii. Daniel Lewis will be presenting an initiative for the university to take their money out of fossil fuels and invest it elsewhere, such as in renewables – with current members of Green Fund.
 - iii. Shelby nominates Emily Earl to present on the work that she has done with student parents
 - iv. Adam Roussas suggested team building exercises with representatives
- **Motion to adjourn (see below)**
 - a. Motion to adjourn meeting (see below)

Legal actions proposed, discussed, or taken:

- Motion (as proposed by Kelli Lycke): I move to adjourn
Ø Motion seconded (by Jhonatan Henao-Munoz); Motion carried without dissent

Dated this 4th day of February 2021
Graduate and Professional Student Council Executive Board
Sarah Abney, Secretary